ANSHA MONTESSORI TEACHER TRAINING INSTITUTE (AMTTI)

- A Division of Ansha Group of Education

MONTESSORI PHILOSOPHY AND METHOD

MONTESSORI TEACHER TRAINING COURSE

Course Code: AMTTC–003

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ABOUT THE INSTITUTION

Ansha Montessori Teacher Training Institute (AMTTI) is a division of the Ansha Group of Education, established in October 2014 with the objective of promoting quality teacher education in early childhood care and education.

The institute is committed to preparing competent and professionally trained educators through a structured Montessori-based approach. AMTTI emphasizes child-centred education, developmentally appropriate practices, and the creation of a prepared learning environment that supports holistic child development.

The institute adopts a balanced training methodology that integrates theoretical foundations with supervised practical experience, enabling trainee teachers to acquire essential pedagogical skills, classroom management techniques, and professional competence required for early childhood education settings.

AMTTI functions with the support of an experienced academic and administrative team and adheres to recognized educational standards to ensure the quality and relevance of its teacher training programmes.

ABOUT THE FOUNDER

Mrs. Shakila Hussain, Founder of Ansha Montessori Teacher Training Institute, holds academic qualifications including M.Phil, M.Ed, and PGDGC. With more than 15 years of experience in the field of education, she has played a key role in establishing and guiding the institute with a focus on academic integrity, professional teacher preparation, and child-centred educational practices.

INSTITUTIONAL PHILOSOPHY

The institute is grounded in Montessori principles such as observation, freedom with responsibility, and respect for the child. AMTTI views the learning environment as a supportive and structured space that encourages independence, responsibility, and active participation in the learning process.

PREFACE

The Montessori Method of education is a system of education for children that seeks to develop natural interests and activities rather than use formal teaching methods. A Montessori classroom places an emphasis on hands-on learning and developing real-world skills.

This material is intended to serve as a ready reference for Montessori teachers. It offers guidelines for the transaction of the concepts highlighted in the course content. It is expected that the learners achieve significant learning outcomes at the end of the course as envisaged in the course curriculum.

The development of this work has been joint venture of subject experts, industrialists and the teachers. The co-ordinators and the advisory team hope that this material is a supporting hand to the Montessori teachers. We are thankful to all those who gave their support and assistance in compiling this material. We welcome constructive criticism and creative suggestions for the improvement of the work.

Regards

Development Team

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Unit 1: BASICS OF MONTESSORI EDUCATION

"The greatest development is achieved during the first years of life, and therefore it is then that the greatest care should be taken. If this is done, then the child does not become a burden; he will reveal himself as the greatest marvel of nature".

Maria Montessori

1.1 INTRODUCTION

The Montessori Method of Education developed by Dr. Maria Montessori, is a child-centred educational approach based on scientific observations of children from birth to adulthood. Dr. Montessori's Method has been time-tested, with over 100 years of success in diverse cultures throughout the world. The Montessori approach is possibly best known today for the contribution it makes to our understanding of the importance of learning through the senses and the development of learning materials that are today referred to as educational toys.

So this unit aims at providing an overview of the historical background, aims, philosophy and principles of Montessori Education. The key concepts of Montessori Education, the triangular relationship between the teacher, child and favourable environment are also discussed in this unit. Special focus is given to all the theoretical aspects of Montessori Education so that the learner can convert knowledge and skills necessary for Montessori teaching

1.2 AIMS OF MONTESSORI EDUCATION

- Assist children in their mental and physical ability to work appropriately
- Allow children to have freedom coupled with responsibility
- Encourage self-discipline, concentration, motivation and sensitivity
- Development of social skills and emotional growth, physical coordination and sensory

development

• Help the children acquire a sense of common humanity that binds people of all races

• Develop children towards global and learning

1.3 DEVELOPMENT OF MONTESSORI METHOD OF EDUCATION

Dr. Maria Montessori, based on her observation, redefined education from the ground up. How Dr. Montessori went about developing the new system of education is an interesting story.

1.3.1 The First Casa-Dei-Bambini

(Teachers) and the child. The centre of activity is the learning by the child and the child occupies the materials and his movements. The first Casa-dei-Bambini was opened in the San Lorenzo district of Rome in 1907.

1.3.4 How Did Montessori Find the Repeating of Exercises?

Dr. Montessori noticed that children repeated exercises of little significance again and again. Montessori noticed children repeating certain activities many times. She observed that repetition was precious to them. They liked meaningful, challenging activities.

1.3.5 How Did Montessori Find the Feeling for Order?

Children's feeling for order was found as a result of a very simple incident. Children put away materials after use. Children but she was doing this, the children got up and stood around her. The teacher felt that they were disobedient. When Montessori watched this, she realized that the children wanted to put things back and to tidy up any disorder.

1.3.6 The Finding of the 'Sensitive Period'

Dr. Montessori interpreted that the child has certain special periods during which particular sensitivities appear. The sensitive period is a limited period of time when the child is particularly receptive to certain stimuli. Montessori provided very appropriate materials for the sensitive period of children. This is possible because the children were free to choose the activities.

1.3.7 Children Like Activities Not the Toys

Though the school contained some really wonderful toys, the children never showed interest in toys. Dr. Montessori showed them how to use the materials. Very soon the children showed intense interest in work. They loved to use heavy, meaningful, challenging activities.

1.3.8 Spontaneous Discipline

In spite of freedom, the children as a whole gave the impression of extra ordinary discipline. They took their own material, made the school tidy and if necessary corrected their companions. Discipline was combined with spontaneity.

1.3.9 Explosion of Writing

One or three illiterate mothers came to Dr. Montessori and asked her to teach their children how to write and read. So Dr. Montessori began to teach them writing. She used sand paper letters. Montessori cut out of cardboard sand papers. Children could touch them with finger tips and feel the shape in writing. She also moved the children's hands should be uniform. One day a child began to write and shout aloud: "I have written".

The other children soon began to watch with interest. Words came and watched with interest words. One unexpected event. But when Dr. Montessori wrote the words, the children could read them. They were interested. It might be because they were already exposed to the early learning.

1.3.10 Reading Came Later

Dr. Montessori was surprised that the children began to understand what reading meant and they associated it with writing later on. While Dr. Montessori was preparing material for teaching printed alphabet for book reading practice, their parents came to tell Dr. Montessori that the children stops in the streets to read the sign boards, so that it was impossible to go out for a walk with them.

1.4 PHILOSOPHY OF MONTESSORI EDUCATION

According to Montessori, there were certain things that were very important for child's natural development. These are following:

1.4.1 Natural Spirituality

Montessori felt that children had within them something wonderful. Something so special that it could be the key to change the world. She saw that they were inherently good and that if allowed to develop freely, they felt calm, confident and happy.

1.4.2 Children thrive on order and structure

The more Montessori worked with the children, the more convinced she was that they had precise inner guides and that the work of adults was to help them to do what they could do.

1.4.3 Children move through sensitive periods

Maria Montessori believed that children pass through phases in which at certain stages throughout their development, they have a predisposition or sensitivity to certain activities. These periods of sensitivity are transitory and particular stages in his development. These periods are transitory and disappear once the child accomplishes a particular stage in his development.

1.4.4 Children learn through their senses

Maria Montessori believed that nothing comes into the mind except through the senses. She observed that children develop their senses, their attention is directed toward the environment. She believed that children loved working with beautiful objects, so all the materials were prepared with the greatest care.

1.4.5 Children need freedom

Maria Montessori believed that freedom was the most important factor in allowing children to grow up as spontaneous, creative individuals. She saw the role of education as providing environments in which children could be independent.

1.4.6 Big Teachers

Montessori called her teachers 'directresses' because she felt that they were more psychologists than teachers and considered that success lay in the deep knowledge of the teacher's own personal development as well as their sensitivity to children.

1.4.7 Little Teachers

As she watched the children busily going about their work, Montessori saw that they could teach each other by watching and listening to others.

1.4.8 Children are natural learners

Montessori says that children undergo extraordinary transformations in overall development when allowed to work freely. She saw that the work of a child therefore was to follow their innate needs. She saw that the child worked for the joy of activity rather than for the result.

1.4.9 Learning Process not Results

Montessori schools believe that children are at their happiest when they are busy involved in process-oriented work. They do not enjoy the learning process because they haven't conditioned to value the product over process.

1.5 PRINCIPLES OF MONTESSORI EDUCATION

The eight principles of Montessori Education are:

• Movement and cognition are closely entwined and movement can enhance thinking and learning
• Learning and well-being are improved when people have a sense of control over their lives
• Children learn better when they are interested in what they are learning
• Tying extrinsic rewards to an activity negatively impacts motivation to engage in that activity
• Collaborative arrangements can facilitate learning
• Learning situated in meaningful contexts is often deeper and richer than learning in abstract contexts
• Particular forms of adult interaction are associated with more optimal child outcomes
• Order in the environment is beneficial to children

1.5.1 Movement and Cognition

The first principle is that movement and cognition is closely entwined. The mind and body are closely connected. Dr. Montessori noted that thinking seems to be expressed by the hands before it can be put into words. Her findings imply that education should involve movement to enhance learning.

1.5.2 Choice

The second principle is free choice. Dr. Montessori noted that children seemed to thrive on having choice and control in their environment, and she observed that children often concentrated better when they were able to choose their own activities.

1.5.3 Interest

Dr. Montessori created situational interest in part by designing materials with which children seemed to want to interact. She also trained Montessori teachers to give lessons in ways that would inspire interest.

1.5.4 Extrinsic rewards are avoided

In Montessori classrooms extrinsic rewards such as gold stars and grades are disruptive to a child's concentration. Indeed, rewards and punishments work against children's natural impulses.

1.5.5 Learning with and from peers

In traditional schooling the teacher gives the children information and children rarely learn from each other directly from materials. Younger children enjoy interacting with older children and are especially interested.

1.5.6 Learning in Context

In traditional schooling children sometimes learn without understanding how their learning applies to anything besides school work. In Montessori classrooms the application and meaning of what was learned should come across to every child. Rather than learning from what teachers and texts say to them children in Montessori learn largely from what teachers and texts say to them.

1.5.7 Order, beauty and child-centred environments

Montessori was high on order in creating very ordered environments in schools. She believed that an orderly environment had an impact on presenting orderly sequences of materials intended to tune the senses.

1.6 OTHER KEY CONCEPTS

1.6.1 Absorbent Mind

The Absorbent Mind is a phenomenon found and defined by Dr. Montessori in the early twentieth century in children up to the age of six, which enables them to absorb knowledge quickly and effortlessly. Dr. Montessori called this process as “absorbent mind”. The child absorbs knowledge unconsciously from birth to three and between three to six the child makes conscious efforts in learning while continuing to acquire skills. The whole of the child is being formed unselectively.

1.6.2 Normalization through work

What is the way to normalize the mentally deviated children? It is the work. Concentration purifies all the problems which are considered as the characteristics of the childhood. Eg: Untidiness, disobedience, laziness, cruelty, destructiveness, tantrums, capriciousness, attachment to a person, submissiveness, possessiveness etc.

Through concentration delight in senses, attachment to a person, submissiveness, possessiveness, inconsistency, instability of attention etc. disappear with normalization.

1.6.3 Nature in education

Maria Montessori felt that human life in community life however, the man still belongs to nature. It is the education that prepares the child of nature for social being. Children should be brought in contact with nature. They should be put into Nature. Children with plants and animals are living. They should take care of plants and animals in the environment. The needs will be satisfied by giving chance to take care of plants and animals in the environment.

1.6.4 Observation & discovery

Through providing long walks, the child is given a chance to observe and discover the environment. The child has to form an understanding of his environment and discover the

various relationships. Children are given freedom to move and choose work. The role of the teacher is to help the child where he needs help. The teacher should not interfere with the child's activities unnecessarily.

1.6.5 Deviated children

Deviations are the manifestations of the body pains or the negative mental dispositions and misbehaviour of a child. Generally mental deviations in two aspects: physical and mental. Physical deviations are visible and mental deviations are not visible and they are manifested in the behaviour.

Deviations can be seen in the child's behaviour.

Following are the ill effects:

1. The child refuses to eat.
2. He will not ask for help.
3. The will of adults to unnecessarily help the child.
4. Children are unable to co-ordinate psychic and physical elements.
5. When an impatient adult scolds the child, he feels a sense of ill-being and confused how to express himself.

1.7 THE THREE KEY COMPONENTS IN MONTESSORI EDUCATION

The teacher, child and environment create the learning triangle.

1.7.1 The Child

A child is susceptible to certain behaviours at certain times. A sensitive period refers to special capacities that exist temporarily in children. It is special period when a child has certain dispositions and limited to the acquisition of particular trait. Once this trait or characteristic has been acquired, the special sensitivity disappears. All children pass through all the sensitive periods but the sequence and timing may vary for each child. One

role of the teacher is to use observation to detect times of sensitivity and provide the setting for optimum learning.

1.7.2 The favourable Environment

In Montessori classrooms children learn best in a prepared environment. A place in which children can do things for themselves. The prepared environment makes learning materials and experiences available to children in an orderly format. Classrooms Montessori described are really what educators advocate.

1.7.3 The teacher

The classroom is prepared by the teacher to encourage independence, freedom within limits and self-discipline. The child through repeated activities makes use of what the environment offers to develop himself, interacting with the environment and other children. The teacher provides support and/or guidance as needed.

When they talk about child-centred education and active learning, freedom is the essential characteristic of the prepared environment. Through freedom children absorb what they find there. Maria Montessori was a master at creating environments for young children that enabled them to be independent, active, and to learn.

1.8 PRACTICE QUESTIONS

- Prepare a chart showing the development of Montessori Method of education.
- Explain the concept 'explosion of writing'.
- Describe your view about sensorial education.
- Explain the triangular relationship among children, favourable environment and teacher.
- Enumerate the differences between Montessori Method and other traditional methods of preschool education.

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Unit 2: METHODS OF MONTESSORI EDUCATION

"Education cannot be effective unless it helps a child open up himself to life."

— **Maria Montessori**

2.1 INTRODUCTION

This unit aims to provide the practical aspects of Montessori education like areas of learning and methods. Learners will get definite, organized information about the different areas in Montessori education like EPL, sensorial, Arithmetic and language, Zoology, Botany, Geography and other cultural aspects of life.

The practical presentation of learning apparatus and the activities are the main features of Montessori Method. They are to be learned by the students through practical demonstrations, continuous self-practice and presenting in front of the children during the teaching practice. Some sample activities are given in this unit. It is not possible to give all activities in this book. Students can make their own practical notes while they are attending the practical classes.

2.2 METHODS OF MONTESSORI EDUCATION

This unit also gives information about the methods of presenting stories and rhymes. The unit enlightens the learners about presentation and the ways of conducting daily observations, study visits, long walks, nature observation etc.

Hence, after finishing this chapter the learner can explain the areas and materials of learning in Montessori Method. Practical use of learning materials in Montessori Method like EPL, sensorial, Arithmetic, Language, Botany, Geography and other cultural aspects of life. Presents the activities using all the apparatus. Lists out the differences between Montessori Method, kindergarten and Froebel Method. Explains the role of preparation and qualities of a Montessori teacher. Conducts daily observation, study visits, long walks and nature observation.

➤ **Motor education:**

It is provided by allowing children to work for themselves and to manage the environment of children's house.

➤ **Muscular education:**

Proper guidance for muscular education. Activities like walking, sitting, holding objects etc. Rhythmic exercises are also taught, enabling children to walk straight and balance themselves properly.

➤ **Experience of practical life:**

Child is given experience of practical life like self-dressing, buttoning, tying, hooking and so on. They are also taught how to lay the table, wash, lay molding etc.

➤ **Writing and Reading:**

After the sense training, child learns to write and read. The muscular training helps the children to use the instrument for writing. The child can also understand the image of the alphabetical science through sand paper letters. Teacher shows how to write and pronounce.

Composition of words through selecting cardboard letters. This learning is a joyful and pleasant experience because children use different colours and sizes and coloured pencils.

➤ **Arithmetic learning:**

Arithmetic learning activities include counting, addition, subtraction, division etc. The arithmetic process is taught in a very concrete way.

➤ **Education of living nature:**

Montessori emphasizes nature study which is a direct education of living nature. The main features of nature study are observation, preparation for observation, practice in patience for expectation and preparation for patience.

The experiment of Montessori education theory and practice is not complete, but it is the beginning of a constructive program of work.

2.3 METHODS OF PRESENTATION OF MONTESSORI MATERIALS AND ACTIVITIES

It is the duty of the teacher to introduce the materials and demonstrate the activities to the child. The teacher must prepare herself and possess the qualities that should be very sympathetic and keen observation of the child to catch and every steps and the movements of the activity.

2.3.1 Presentation of activities in house of children

Presentation helps the child to develop an image of perfection and understand the meaning of the activity. The teacher does not correct his error. It helps a child to choose the materials and do the activity. The teacher should guide the child only if it is absolutely necessary.

2.3.2 Types of presentation

✓ **Individual presentation**
✓ **Group presentation**
✓ **Collective presentation**

Individual presentation is the one in which only one child attends.

Group presentation is when more than one child attends and collective presentation is when all the children in the community are invited and majority attends.

2.3.3 Types of activities

✓ Individual activity
✓ Group activity
✓ Collective activity

2.4 THINGS TO REMEMBER WHEN PRESENTING THE MONTESSORI ACTIVITIES

• Invite the child to participate. As simple as this seems, there is a world of difference between being invited to work and being told to do it. Any mild interference between teaching and practice should be avoided.

• Move with grace and dignity. Every movement of the teacher should be slow and deliberate. This helps the child to observe and imitate the movements clearly.

• Show, don't tell. Children need repeated exposure to new vocabulary to make it part of their repertoire. When showing materials, ensure that the child understands the term and can connect it successfully with its corresponding object.

• Stop and put away. If the child is not interested or is making mistakes, put the activity away. If the child is interested, allow another opportunity to present it later. Stop before you and the child become frustrated.

• Smile and relax. Watching children develop and learn is a joyful experience.

2.5 SCOPE OF LEARNING IN MONTESSORI APPROACH

Natural tendencies children are recognized and were discovered through Dr. Montessori's scientific observation. The Montessori curriculum includes an atmosphere prepared for the development of children and encompasses in paper, the main areas of the Montessori curriculum are:

➤ Early practical life activities

➤ Sensorial activities

➤ Mathematics

➤ Culture (Geography, Zoology, Botany, Music, art and yoga)

➤ Enrichment programs (Music, Dramatic arts, visual arts, cooking etc.)

2.5.1 Early Practical Life activities

Exercises of practical life are introduced to the children so that they are equipped with daily practical life skills. The activities are simple performing tasks that improve children's daily routines such as pouring water from jug, spooning beans from one bowl to another, threading beads etc.

The activities are designed to provide real-life experience that assists the children's coordination and concentration. Exercises of coordination of the children's movement helps them gain control over their body movements. When children are able to perform these exercises they develop self-respect and self-esteem. They gain fine motor skills and confidence. As the children are working together in classroom environment these activities help them learn to co-operate.

2.5.2 Sensorial Activities

Sensorial activities help children to refine the senses. Montessori believed that senses are the gateways of knowledge. Children explore the world around them through the constant use of all their senses. The sensorial materials and activities are designed to develop the ability to discriminate among various sensory impressions.

The materials are designed to isolate one sense at a time and to introduce quantities such as colour, form, texture, size, weight, sound, smell and dimensions.

The children's manipulation of the sensorial materials develops essential skills such as differentiation, independent judgment, estimation, discrimination and order, which also assists in laying the foundation for future Mathematics work.

2.5.3 LANGUAGE

Language curriculum aims to enable the child to read through a series of graded exercises and activities. In the first stage they learn phonetic sounds through various activities, recognizing and blending the sounds. They start with consonant sounds and gradually

progress to consonant digraphs and vowel digraphs. The last stage of reading is the introduction to Early Grammar, Comprehension and Creative Writing.

2.5.3.1 Literacy materials

Most of the literacy materials used are teacher made.

(a) Writing

✓ Insets of design (metal insets) encourage pencil control.

✓ Sand paper letters introduce the child to letter sounds and shapes.

✓ Moveable alphabets help the child to build words.

✓ Tracing of letters helps the child in writing.

✓ Use of chalk boards and slates help children identify suitable words for word building.

(b) Reading

Most Montessori nursery schools organize their reading activities into color coded levels.

Pink level reading: The first level of reading focuses on three letter words consisting of the regular pattern consonant, vowel and consonant (such as pin, mat).

Blue level reading: When children are competent in decoding three letter words, they are introduced to initial and final blends, the schwa vowel, double consonants and long vowel sounds.

Green level reading: This level of reading requires competence at both the pink and blue levels. It focuses on specific phonogram or digraph such as ‘ar’, ‘ee’, ‘oa’ etc.

Red level reading: This level goes beyond simple moving on to the next green box, which identifies new spellings.

Reading is supported by the use of pictures highlighted by the colour of the letters which represent the given phonogram or digraph.

Grammar

Grammar is introduced very naturally as a part of language learning.

(1) Noun labels – red

(2) Singular and plural boxes introducing the formation of plurals.

(3) Noun and adjective games, highlighting the function of adjectives and their position.

(4) Article games

(5) Verb boxes – pink

(6) Preposition boxes, highlighting the function of prepositions.

(7) Farm boxes, building sentences based around a theme.

2.5.4 MATHEMATICS

The Montessori Mathematics apparatus serve as a concrete method where the children learn concepts of mathematics. Number rods and Golden Beads are used to introduce the child to the decimal system. Children learn to recognize numbers, exploring both quantities and symbols. They work with addition, subtraction, multiplication and division, decimal system and fractions.

(a) Counting:

The child builds up an understanding of quantity by manipulating objects and associating them with numerals.

The apparatus used are:

(1) Number rods

(2) Sand paper numerals

(3) Number rods and cards

(4) Cards and counters

(b) The decimal system

Golden beads (which can be replaced by the wooden decimal materials commercially produced) are used to give the child the understanding of the decimal system and the

numerals cards which use colour coding to represent the given hierarchies and place value are used.

(c) Group operations with golden beads

These activities introduce addition, subtraction, multiplication and division operations and give the child a concrete experience of numbers 1 to 10 and relationships of decimal hierarchies. They introduce the concept of changing from one decimal hierarchy to another.

(d) Counting 10 to 99

(1) Ten boards (Seguin Board A) numbers 11–19 using new materials.

(2) Ten boards (Seguin Boards B) numbers 10–99 using new materials.

(e) Bead chains 100/1000 (conservatory reversibility of number)

(f) Addition and Subtraction

(1) Snake game (simple addition)

(2) Number boards

(3) Addition strip board, introducing adding on, practicing recording

Subtraction

(1) Subtraction with short bead stair (subtraction equations)

(2) Small number rod (recording answers)

(g) Tables

Children start working on tables, still using objects that they manipulate.

(h) Charts

These charts reinforce previous learning of the number operations and help children memorize the answers to the equations.

(1) Addition chart A and B

(2) Subtraction chart A and B

(3) Multiplication chart A and B

(4) Division chart A and B

(i) Fractions

Children start to use the fraction materials using fraction symbols and combining them with the fraction pieces. They learn about numerators, denominators, equivalence and reduction.

(j) Measurement

Children learn measurement using different materials. They also use the long rods and learn measuring and recording. Measuring tape. They learn about clocks and time recording.

Money is introduced around the age of five. Money is introduced in the form of play.

2.5.5 CULTURE

Cultural studies provide a foundation for children to learn about the world around them. It encompasses Science, Geography, Botany, History and General Knowledge. The cultural materials and topics which the children explore are teacher made.

2.6 METHODS OF STORY TELLING

Story telling is an important method in Montessori education. It helps the child to develop imagination, language skills and listening power. Story telling should be meaningful to the students.

2.7.1 Points of effective story telling

1. **Setting down:** Before starting the story, all children should be given time and space to settle down comfortably. Story helps the children to concentrate.
2. **Ensuring concentration:** Stories help to attract children and increase their concentration power. For this, we can use some actions, voice modulations, stick

puppets, role play etc. Asking also be done with facial expressions. Dramatic presentation or elements of creative drama will also be utilized. Sometimes questions can be asked to check their understanding. There are many other techniques to catch or check their attention.

3. **Capturing hearing:** The story is a means of increasing listening power of the students.

4. **Understanding language:** Stories help to develop the language skills. New words are introduced and children learn to use them correctly.

5. **Moral:** The story can be used to give moral through stories. So, there can be a moral which should be understandable.

6. **Imagination:** Through story telling imaginary scope will be explained in such a way. When we say about imaginary scope children can imagine thoroughly.

7. **Power of story:** Story will include chances for thinking. Questions can be asked for thinking power like “what will happen next?” “how can we save the little rabbit from the lion?”

8. **Power of dramatic stories:** We give some solutions for a problem inside stories. When we give some solutions for a problem children will get interest in listening to stories.

9. **Improving vocabulary:** Some new vocabulary can be included in all stories and the meaning can be explained in this way stories also help in vocabulary development and for intellectual powers.

2.8 ROLE, PREPARATION AND QUALITIES IN MONTESSORI EDUCATION

2.8.1 Teacher's Role

The teacher should observe, follow and guide bringing wisdom, thoughtfulness, and experience to the child's academic, social, and emotional exploration.

Learning means helping the children to acquire skills and knowledge. The teacher's role is to allow children to develop at their own pace. Learning is initiated and carried out by the children themselves.

The teacher establishes guidelines for the curriculum and the community. As a result pattern of good work, habits and sense of responsibility and cooperation are established in the classroom.

2.8.2 Preparation

A good Montessori teacher must have imagination and faith in children. The Montessori teacher shows great affection, interest and energy when she finds an interesting piece of work. So the Montessori teacher should prepare herself and the environment.

✓ The first step of the preparation is keeping the environment and all the apparatus well arranged, clean, perfect and shining. Nothing should be missing for use. As the environment includes teacher's appearance also, she must be attractive, pleasing, tidy, calm and dignified.

✓ The second step of a Montessori teacher is to attract and mesmerize the child because children like the teacher. She can tell stories and jokes. She can sing rhymes and songs. The child may say "how lovely my teacher is; she is just like my mamma".

✓ The third step is to allow the child to carry out his activities by himself. The teacher will have to control herself and observe the child's work. The teacher will have to allow the child to repeat his work and get satisfied.

✓ The fourth step is to give correct presentation. Every action of the teacher can be a call and invitation to the child.

✓ The child's urge comes when the child begins to take an interest in something. Usually the experience of practical life is useless and boring to give the children sensorial and other apparatus before they begin to show interest. The teacher should not interrupt any work, because this interest is fragile and delicate. An interruption may break it and it may vanish forever.

✓ So the teacher must be very careful. She must not interrupt the work of the child even if the wrong help or a look is enough to interrupt or destroy the activity and interest of the child. The duty of the teacher is to look, observe and follow the child.

✓ The child has exhausted all the possibilities of those materials she was using before. The teacher must know when to present new material. The teacher's skill in observation and presentation depends on her personality and intelligence.

PRACTICE QUESTIONS

- Explain the importance of story telling in Montessori education.
- Describe the points of effective story telling.
- Explain the role of a Montessori teacher.
- What are the qualities of a Montessori teacher?
- Explain the preparation needed for a Montessori teacher.

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Unit 3: DESIGNING OF A MONTESSORI INSTITUTION

"The word education must not be understood in the sense of teaching but of assisting the psychological development of the child."

— *Maria Montessori*

3.1 INTRODUCTION

The success of Montessori education depends much on the specially prepared Montessori environment. So this unit aims to provide the learners with the information regarding the Montessori classroom design and the nature, facilities and preparation of special Montessori environment.

The unit covers six chapters starting from the preparation of the environment and ends with the maintenance of the environment. The learners will get a detailed list of didactic apparatus / Montessori materials and way of handling the apparatuses. Another topic of discussion is arrangement of materials and areas and furniture. Overall, the unit emphasizes the infrastructure support which is the key factor in Montessori education.

3.2 DESIGNING OF THE MONTESSORI CLASSROOM

Montessori classrooms are peaceful, happy places designed to meet the developmental needs of each child in every stage of life. There is no focal centre to the classroom, this reduces that the teacher is not the focus of the children's attention. Instead, there are learning centres throughout the room which are inviting, colourful, natural materials, fascinating cultural objects and interesting pictures on the wall, offer the children complex sensory and intellectual experiences.

But Montessori classroom or today can have many learning centres with self-directed activities or circular seating for Socratic discussion. Students in these environments

learn from each other rather than being competitive, students are wealth of information with each other and students might have the role of mentor, tutor or discussion leader.

Much of the didactic materials students work with in Montessori classrooms are self-corrective which provide students the opportunity for self-evaluation and self-correction. By assisting children in solving problems and evaluating their own work, the materials provide unique process of scaffolding. Students have freedom of movement to choose activities and move on to next task.

3.3 INFRASTRUCTURE AND ITS NEED IN A MONTESSORI INSTITUTION

Materials are to be arranged neatly in the order of the learning areas like Preliminary materials, EPL, Sensorial materials, Arithmetic materials, Language materials, Botany, Geography and other cultural materials.

A prepared environment encompasses the following:

- A freedom of movement and freedom of choice
- Structure and order in the arrangement of the materials
- An environment that is attractive, warm and inviting
- Materials that provide active learning experiences
- Infrastructure facilities needed in a Montessori House of Children

3.3.1 Indoor

- A single flexible indoor working hall or big rooms for lessons, individual and/or group work and indoor activities. Blue linen curtains and blinds. Mat sized commodes, taps suitable for children's height.
- An area for Arts and Crafts activity, performance and meetings.

• Shelves for language and sensory corner.

• Area for practical work.

• Dining hall with attached kitchen and storage.

• Space for teachers and staff.

• Visitors waiting area.

3.3.2 Outdoor

• Sports facilities

• Playground should be fenced

• There should be facilities and enough number of equipments for climbing, sliding, swinging, seesaw, hiding and engaging in different activities.

• Sand area for playing in sand

• Area to grow vegetables or fruit for consumption or sale are needed

This will provide a rich experience for students to observe and explore.

3.4 PRINCIPLES OF DESIGNING OF THE MONTESSORI CLASSROOM

3.4.1 Freedom

Montessori believed that children must be free to explore and follow their interests. Freedom enhances their potential and increasing their knowledge of the world around them. With freedom children must experience freedom of movement, freedom of exploration and freedom from interference from others.

This freedom ultimately leads to a genuine freedom: freedom of choice.

3.4.2 Structure and Order

While structure and order seem counterintuitive to the aforementioned freedom, nothing could be farther from the truth. Structure and order in the environment directly reflect the sense of structure and order in the universe. By using the

Montessori classroom children internalize the order and microcosm of the universe, thus making sense of the world in which he lives.

3.6 RESPONSIBILITY OF THE CHILD

- The child has the right to work alone.
- The child must be given freedom.
- The child learns through observation, thinking and testing.

He or she must use the material respectfully. She/he must not harm the material themselves or others. The material may not be used in a way that harms the child or others.

The child should keep materials on his/her rug.
The child must roll the mat properly and take an exercise.
Child is responsible for putting up used rugs, placing the chair under the table and returning his other work to the shelf.

No child is allowed to interfere another child's work. The child must leave the work when completed.

The child is not allowed to interfere or disturb others in the classroom.

3.7 MONTESSORI CLASSROOM MATERIALS / THE DIDACTIC APPARATUS

Didactic apparatus is synonymous with auto regulative. It is a method used in Montessori classrooms between the ages of 3 and 6. Created to satisfy the most critical periods of children's life. Montessori apparatus is child's point of view, to satisfy the innate craving for activity. It is especially effective in the development of the senses.

The Montessori apparatus is self-corrective in nature. The child really understands what he is doing and because of the self correcting element that prevails, that is developed in him, initiates self control and concentration.

The essential apparatus include:

3.7.1 Preliminary Activities (Exercises of Practical Life)

Some of the materials used in preliminary activities can be purchased from a manufacturer or supplier.

1. Cloth peg (Pegs & squares both)
2. String tying (long strings, beads, 2 plastic bowls)
3. Squeezing (piece of sponge and 2 bowls)
4. Threading beads (beads of different sizes and strings)
5. Pouring water (plate, 1 plastic cups, 2 funnel, 1 filter)
6. Folding
7. Sorting activity (Different coloured beads & bowls)
8. Grinding (pounding) small metal grinding set
9. Chapathi making (small chapathi roller set)
10. Jigsaw Puzzles – Leaf, Frog, Fish, Flower, Tree, Horse etc.

3.7.2 Exercises of Practical Life

These materials can be purchased from a manufacturer or supplier of Montessori apparatus.

1. Tray for carrying

2. Carrying mat
3. Fastening cloth
4. Fastening Coat button
5. Fastening hooks
6. Fastening laces
7. Fastening buckles
8. Fastening Velcro
9. Fastening jacket zip
10. Tray + small tumblers and napkin for pouring activity
11. Small broom and dust pan for sweeping activity
12. Small dust pan and small brush for cleaning activity

3.7.3 SENSORIAL APPARATUS

1. Cylinder Blocks
2. Pink Tower
3. Brown Stairs
4. Brown Stairs Polished
5. Long Stairs
6. Knobless Cylinders
7. Secondary Colour Tablets
8. Geometrical Solids

9. Touch Boards
10. Fabric Box
11. Smelling Bottles
12. Sound Cylinders
13. Tactile Tablets
14. Touch Tablets
15. Thermic Tablets – Small
16. Geometrical Cabinet + Presentation Tray
17. Geometrical Form Cards (3 Boxes)
18. Drawing Insets
19. Binomial Squares (Optional)
20. Trinomial Squares (Optional)
21. Binomial Cubes (Optional)
22. Trinomial Cubes (Optional)
23. Decanomial Squares (Optional)

3.7.4 MATHEMATICS APPARATUS

1. Number Rods
2. Cards for number rods
3. Sandpaper Numbers
4. Spindle Boxes

5. Cards + Counters
6. Traditional Names
7. Introduction to Decimal System
8. Decimal Bead Material
9. Golden Beads with Number Cards 1 to 9000
10. Dynamic Cubes & Squares
11. Number Cards 1 to 9000
12. Small Number Cards (1–1000)
13. Arrows Squares
14. Add and Subtract Chains with Bead
15. Coloured Bead Stairs
16. Bead Material for Teen Board
17. Squared Boards Ten (10 to 99)
18. Hundred Board (Optional)
19. Addition Strip Board including Strip Tray
20. Addition Strip Board including Strip Tray
21. Box for Addition Board
22. Subtraction Strip Board
23. Box for Subtraction Board
24. Multiplication Board with bead box

25. Box for Multiplication Board
26. Division Board with Bead Box
27. Box for Division Board
28. Fraction Insets
29. Inscribed and Concentric Figures
30. Stamp Game
31. Row Bead Frame
32. Fraction Circles Wooden with Stand
33. Control Charts
34. Fraction Circles Wooden with Stand
35. Long Division Set

3.7.5 LANGUAGE – ENGLISH MATERIALS

1. Sandpaper Letters – Cursive
2. Sandpaper Letters – Print
3. Sandpaper Letters – Capital
4. Movable Alphabet – Print
5. Phonograms – Print
6. Movable Alphabet – Cursive large
7. Movable Alphabet – Cursive small
8. Cards for reading

9. Vowel Boxes – Cursive (1 Pair)
10. Vowel Boxes – Print (2 Pair)
11. Vowel Boxes – Print Uncut (1 Pair)
12. Grammar Boxes (8)
13. Logical Analysis Set of 2
14. Grammar Symbols

3.7.6 LANGUAGE – HINDI

1. Sandpaper Letters – Hindi
2. Movable Alphabet Hindi – Single Large Box
3. Hindi Matra Chart

3.7.7 LANGUAGE – MALAYALAM

1. Movable Alphabet (Malayalam)
2. Sandpaper Letters (Malayalam)
3. Malayalam Vowels Chart
4. Malayalam Consonant Chart

3.7.8 GEOGRAPHY

1. Geography land form cards with stands – 6 pairs
2. Map Puzzle India
3. Map Puzzle World
4. Map Puzzle Asia

5. Puzzle Maps

3.7.9 BOTANY & ZOOLOGY

1. Botany Cabinet
2. Botany Form Cards

3.7.10 ACCESSORIES

1. Small Trays
2. Small Mats
3. Green Bowl (mos)

3.8 ARRANGEMENT OF MATERIALS IN DIFFERENT SECTIONS

Montessori apparatus and other learning materials are to be arranged neatly and systematically in different shelves to help children to see and take any material without hurting himself or other materials. It is important to arrange cupboards/shelves to keep each of the following categories of items.

1. Materials for preliminary activities
2. Materials for experience of practical life activities
3. Materials for sensorial activities
4. Materials for arithmetic activities
5. Materials for language activities
6. Materials for botany and zoology activities
7. Materials for geography education
8. Materials for art and craft activities

3.8.1 The Blue Line and Activities

The blue line is marked in the main hall for assembling children. Blue line area is marked in an oval shape on the floor. Normally children engage in individual activities during the first session.

In blue line time children will gather around the blue line. Group activities like conversation, discussions, exercises, songs, stories are conducted at the blue line. Attendance is checked at blue line.

3.8.2 Furniture

Montessori house of children should be furnished with proper furniture. It should look like a house of children. Everything should be arranged neatly and in an orderly manner.

Some of the materials should have a cover. The materials without cover should be placed on separate benches or stools. The furniture should be dusted and maintained neatly. The followings are the essential furniture in a Montessori House of Children.

1. Mat Box – Iron (2 × 1.5 × 1.5) a big strong carton container
2. Stand / shelves for keeping Montessori materials – 6 nos (5 × 1 × 2.5)
3. Stands and hangers – 3 (for hanging cleaning materials)
4. Small low tables – 6 (for writing and demonstration activities)
5. Big low tables – 4 (for doing activities)
6. Small wooden chairs without handle for children (for demonstration) – 2
7. Sitting mats (preferably with thick cloth)

8. Mats for putting the materials (preferably with thick cloth)
9. Furniture for arranging reading corner and book shelf
10. Furniture for office and teachers
11. Furniture for dining (if necessary) normally children sit on mats on the floor

3.9 PRACTICE QUESTIONS

• Find ways to reduce the cost of establishing a Montessori House of Children.

• Montessori classrooms are peaceful, happy places designed to meet the developmental needs of each child in every stage of life. Substantiate.

• List out some of the essential apparatuses to be ensured in a Montessori classroom.

• Prepare a checklist for apparatus in Mathematical area.

• Maintaining the environment is an important aspect of Montessori Education. Explain.

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Unit 4 - ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION IN MONTESSORI EDUCATION

"The greatest gifts we can give our children are the roots of responsibility and the wings of independence."

Dr. Maria Montessori

4.1 INTRODUCTION

Evaluation is the essential part of Montessori education. In this unit the following aspects of evaluation are discussed: Methods of assessment and evaluation – continuous observation and formative assessment of activities, performance assessment. Evaluation of written work. Purpose of assessment. Teacher's role in assessment. The concept of self-correction. Remedies. Records to be maintained for individual child.

After completing this Unit, trainees are expected to acquire the skills to assess and evaluate the children in Montessori Method. They will be theoretically and practically well aware of the methods of assessment and evaluation, formative assessment, summative assessment, the best way of assessing each child, specific activities and outcomes in each area, eight characteristics of the authentic Montessori learning experience.

4.2 APPROACH TO ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION IN MONTESSORI EDUCATION

Instead of looking at evaluation as the end-product of education or what students have memorized, Montessori education looks at assessment as a means of

enhancing student learning. Formative assessment focuses on what students are learning, where they are going, and what they need to get there.

Montessori teachers around the world have been using formative assessment for over a hundred years.

Assessment is to know how well the child has absorbed the learning and what type of help or support the child needs to progress further. The goal of assessment is to help the child. The teacher observes and documents the child's progress. This information helps the teacher to plan activities that meet the needs of the child and promote development.

4.2.1 Formative Assessment

Formative assessment is the general everyday observation and monitoring of student progress. This type of assessment provides ongoing feedback to teachers, students and parents about how well the student is processing information, whether he understood the lesson, and whether he mastered the skill.

Formative assessment tells us if the student needs additional instruction and practice, or if he/she is ready to move on to the next activity in the sequence. Montessori materials have a built-in control of error, which gives the student immediate opportunity to self-correct.

Montessori teachers use formative assessments as part of their daily routine. Lessons are presented, children are observed, assessed, and recorded. The teacher makes notes on the child's lessons regarding progress and difficulty.

The teacher observes how the child is using the material, how much help the child requires, and whether the child can use the material independently. Based on these

observations, the teacher decides when to present new material or repeat previous lessons.

4.2.2 Summative Assessment

While the goal of formative assessment is to monitor a student's progress and guide ongoing instruction, summative assessment is the assessment of the final product. Summative assessments measure how much a student has learned up to a certain point.

Certain summative assessments measure how much a student has learned in a specific area. Exams, term papers, midterms, finals, and standardized tests are examples of summative assessment meant to rank and hold students (and teachers) accountable for learning.

4.3 APPROACH TO EVALUATE A MONTESSORI CHILD

In Montessori schools, children are not assigned grades or test scores as a way to evaluate children's progress. While it is wonderful that we don't subject children to these sorts of ways to estimate their progress, teachers and parents still need some way to evaluate children's progress.

How do we measure children's growth and development in a way that lets us know how they're doing without using tests or grades? Another important (and related) question is this: how can we know if a child is having an authentic Montessori experience?

In other words, is the child thriving? Is he happy? Is he engaged? Is he learning?

First of all, there should be some kind of systematic and formalized way to evaluate children's progress.

The second part of the evaluation can include the child's own work. Photographs of the child's creative writing, drawing, art projects, and even photographs of the child at work.

The third part of the assessment should include a written portion that summarizes the child's progress as observed by the teacher. Observation notes and anecdotal records are helpful to briefly mention the general characteristics of a Montessori child and how this particular child is moving ahead in each area.

4.4 CHARACTERISTICS OF THE AUTHENTIC MONTESSORI LEARNING EXPERIENCE

Some consistent traits show up in Montessori children regardless of the type of school they attend or area of the world in which they live.

4.4.1 Independence

Besides the obvious displays of independence like being able to choose work, Montessori children exhibit a certain autonomy that marks the Montessori child. They are used to doing things themselves rather than having an adult do everything for them.

4.4.2 Confidence

The Montessori child develops confidence through well-structured experiences. The child has confidence in his ability to solve problems, try new things, and succeed with patience.

4.4.3 Self-discipline

Montessori enables children to make the right choices without adult intervention. The child cannot achieve self-discipline without instruction and help from the teachers and parents.

4.4.4 Intrinsic motivation

The child is intrinsically motivated. If the teacher or parent is giving direction, the child will never get a chance to hear that “inner voice”.

4.4.5 Ability to handle external authority

The child in the Montessori environment is treated with respect. They are well-prepared to take directions from adults with patience.

4.4.6 Academic achievement

While we do not wish to make academics the focus of a Montessori education, they are important. It is important to know which materials are presented and when, and whether or not the child has completed them successfully.

Many Montessori schools avoid standardized testing, but it is perfectly acceptable to evaluate kids with short, informal one-on-one sessions with an adult.

4.4.7 Spiritual awareness

The Montessori philosophy recognizes that a child has more than just a mind and body; they possess a soul as well. The child’s soul needs to be nourished through art, music, literature, nature, moral lessons, and relationships.

4.4.8 Responsible citizenship

A Montessori curriculum stresses the interdependence of all living things. Global awareness will come quite naturally to the Montessori child. They will be interested in current events, in helping others less fortunate than themselves, and in looking for ways to make the world a better place.

4.5 OUTCOMES

Any child who develops the eight characteristics mentioned above is going to be well prepared to succeed at anything they attempt to do. So let's make sure we are preparing them well.

Sensorial activities

After completing the sensorial activities, children will be able to:

1. Use all the senses keenly.
2. Work with improved motor coordination.
3. Act more intelligently.
4. Respond in a variety of ways to what they see, hear, smell, touch and feel.
5. Express and communicate their ideas, thoughts and feelings by using words.
6. Move with confidence, imagination and safety.

Exercises of practical life (EPL) Activities

After completing the exercises of practical life activities, the child will be able to:

1. Grow independent with the performance of everyday activities.
2. Taking care of oneself.
3. Taking care of environment and
4. Taking care of social behaviour.
5. Realize importance of keeping health and cleanliness habits.
6. Develop coordination and concentration.

Language development (English)

After completing the activities in this topic, the child will be able to:

1. Recognise sounds of the spoken language.
2. Recognise the symbols for the sounds.
3. Read and write the spoken language.
4. Hear and say sounds in words.
5. Recognise and read familiar words.
6. Read sentences of familiar and common words and simple sentences fluently.
7. Write one's name, labels and captions of familiar things and simple sentences.
8. Spell words correctly and use it effectively to form recognisable letters most of which are correctly formed.
9. Solve everyday words problem.
10. Read and write or construct numbers up to 9999.

Cultural aspects of life

After completing the activities related to this topic, the child will be able to:

1. Observe oneself and identify as part of the social groups like family, school, friends & neighbours.
2. Observe carefully some features of living things, objects and events they observe.
3. Look closely at similarities, differences, patterns and change.

4. Identify why things happen and how things work.
5. Observe, find out about and identify features in the place they live.
6. Find out features of environment they like and dislike.
7. Those features should be used for creating artworks.
8. Acquire skills to keep healthy, behave well and to use tools.

Stories

After completing the activities:

1. Listen with enjoyment and respond to stories and makeup their own stories.
2. Respond in a variety of ways to what they see and hear.
3. Express and communicate ideas, thoughts and feelings by using a wide range of materials, suitable tools, imaginative role play and movement.
4. Extend vocabulary, explore the meaning and sounds of new words.
5. Speak clearly and audibly with confidence and control and show awareness of the listener.
6. Use language to imagine and recreate roles and experiences.

Rhymes & songs

After completing the activities related to this topic, the child will be able to:

1. Extend their vocabulary, explore their meanings and sounds of new words.
2. Listen and say sounds in the order in which they occur.
3. Sing songs and rhymes with actions, expression and enjoyment.
4. Perform and enjoy music, movement and rhythm.

5. Respond to music by creating movements.

4.6 PROCESS REPORTS IN THE MONTESSORI CLASSROOM

Montessori education aims at understanding the child's progress report in developing the child. Our progress reports must reflect the individual child's progress. Many parents and teachers alike are unsure of how progress reports actually work in the Montessori learning environment.

4.6.1 Types of Progress Reports

There are different ways to assess each student's academic and social development. There are two basic types of Montessori progress reports.

The checklist format:

The checklist format is a checklist of important skills broken down into specific areas, which are assessed by an evaluator.

The narrative-style report:

The narrative progress report is the most commonly used form of assessment in Montessori classrooms. It conveys a sense that one cannot gain a true feeling as to what their child is learning. The narrative progress report recognizes that each child is unique and whose progress cannot truly be understood or assessed by using a checklist approach.

It gives a more detailed description of the child's work and choices. It allows parents to better understand the child's progress.

Narrative progress report also allows the Montessori teacher to address character development, something which is nearly impossible to do with a checklist.

4.6.2 The Language of Progress Reports

The language of the progress report is extremely important for teachers to reflect upon and remember that each child, no matter how challenging, has good qualities.

These qualities need to be brought to the forefront of the progress report. Parents are always happy to know that you think well of their child. Negative behaviour or difficulties should be addressed in a constructive way.

4.6.3 Records to be Maintained as Part of Evaluation

Montessori teachers keep records for continuous progress during the time the child attends the school. The school can design the progress card or assessment sheets for continuous progress during the time he/she attends the school.

The school can design the format considering all areas of progress and the evaluation periods. There are different methods for marking the assessment details.

After one month, this will be given to the parents during the open house programs.

4.7 PRACTICE QUESTIONS

- Distinguish between formative and summative Assessment.
- Discuss the Narrative Assessment.
- Explain the ways of evaluating a Montessori child.
- Explain the role of observation as a tool of Assessment in Montessori education.

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Academic Note

Learners are encouraged to supplement this material with practical observations, classroom activities, and reference resources to enhance their understanding of early childhood care and education.